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Supporting Information for
Geographical Diversity of Peer Reviewers Shapes Author Success

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Supporting Text

Mechanisms. Country homophily might operate via four mechanisms: information, tastes, biases, and differential self-selection. We conceptualize information and tastes as mechanisms related to the content of what is being evaluated (manuscripts), whereas biases are related to the identities of evaluators and creators of the evaluated objects (reviewers and authors). Therefore, hiding authors' identities should only affect reviewer homophily through the biases mechanism.

By "information" we refer to evaluators' private knowledge of the work and authors they review. Reviewers may have additional information about research from their own country for several reasons. They may share professional connections with the authors, such as professional societies and co-authors. The lower travel costs associated with geographic proximity may also increase exposure to authors' work at seminars and conferences. They may also work on problems or use methods that are geographically concentrated. The additional information reviewers may have about same-country research can translate into more favorable reviews, theoretically, due to Bayesian updating—reviewers make assessments of ideas in a manuscript by updating their prior assessments of those ideas, based on information outside the manuscript. If additional information is associated with holding an even slightly positive prior, the updated assessment will tend to be more positive (1). Empirically, several studies have found expertise to be associated with more positive assessments (2, 3), although in settings without self-selection into reviewing, the relationship may be reversed (4).

By "tastes" we refer to evaluators' partiality toward the substance and style of a work. A reviewer may have particular tastes regarding research topics or methods, or even writing style. The existence of cultural zones and local tastes is often discussed outside of science (5, 6). Location determines the resources available in the production of knowledge (7) and lay community perceptions of innovation (8), which gives reason to suspect that geography is a factor in judging science. However, the universal and disinterested character of science makes the notion of geographically clustered tastes controversial in the evaluation of supposedly objective research (9). While evidence on regional tastes among academics is sparse, at least one account provides testimony that research tastes cluster by location (10). SCRs may have research tastes similar to those of the submitting authors, resulting in systematically positive reviews from the former.

By "biases" we refer to evaluators' explicit or implicit affinity toward particular researchers based on their identity. These biases may be cognitive and unconscious, or they may be strategic and conscious. For example, a reviewer with a conflict of interest may be strategically biased in their evaluation if they are aware of an author's identity. Randomly hiding authors' identities is a common strategy for uncovering these biases. Several studies have detected biases among editors and reviewers along social dimensions like prestige (11–13) and geography (14–17). These biases are often conceptualized as a hierarchy with dominant and marginalized groups where the dominant group is reliably favored by all types of reviewers (*e.g.,* reviewers all prefer work from wealthy countries). Instead, we focus on how reviewers might be systematically more positive based on their relationship to authors. As noted above, authors of one country may have more professional ties with SCRs than non-SCRs, inducing conflicts of interest. Or perhaps seeing an author's country triggers nationalistic biases in SCRs and not in non-SCRs. In either case, biases could explain SCR positivity.

Instrumental Variable Approach. We conduct a secondary, exploratory analysis of whether double-anonymization would be an effective policy to mitigate geographical representation bias. Unlike the homophily analysis, anonymization status does not vary within-manuscript, so comparisons must be made across manuscripts. However, naively comparing evaluations across anonymized and non-anonymized submissions may give a biased estimate of the anonymization effect, because certain types of authors may have systematically chosen or avoided anonymization. To address this concern, we use the instrumental variables (IV) approach. IV accounts for the self-selection problem by leveraging an auxiliary variable (the instrument), which for this study is the availability of the anonymization option.

As mentioned in Materials and Methods, this IV analysis is enabled by the introduction of a voluntary anonymization policy across IOP's journals. Ideally, this analysis would simply require a t-test for the significance of the interaction effect of anonymization and SCR status, $\beta 3$ in the simplified structural Equation 13 below.

$$Positivity_{ij} = \beta_1 Anon_i + \beta_2 SCR_{ij} + \beta_3 Anon_i * SCR_{ij} + \epsilon_{ij} \quad (13)$$

However, since anonymization status is likely endogenous due to self-selection or other omitted variables, the interaction between anonymization and SCR status would also be endogenous. We use the availability of the option to anonymize as an instrumental variable to estimate the causal effect of anonymization on reviewer positivity (IV in Table S6). For anonymization policy availability to be a valid instrument, three assumptions must be met: exogeneity, relevance, and the exclusion restriction.

The exogeneity criterion implies that the timing of policy availability across journals should be orthogonal to the error term of the structural model (i.e., regressing the endogenous, independent variable and instrument on the dependent variable together). In other words, policy availability should be independent of any unobserved variables correlated with review positivity. This assumption is supported by the data-generating process, since IOP's staggered rollout was done in an arbitrary order in consultation with the last author [M.T.]. This quasi-random rollout means the availability of the anonymization option assigned unrelatedly or exogenously to reviewers' behavior. Self-selection into treatment (anonymization) is one form of endogeneity between the treatment and the outcome (review positivity). Using randomized assignment (anonymization option) as an instrument sidesteps the issue of selection into treatment because now we are estimating the effect of assignment, which we assume is only correlated with the treatment and not with any other determinants (see discussion on exclusion restriction below), on the outcome. Randomized assignment also enables a valid ITT analysis.

The relevance assumption implies that the ability to anonymize should have a strong effect on authors' choice to anonymize. Conventionally, strength is measured using the F-statistic of the instruments in the first-stage regressions. With two endogenous variables, we conduct separate F-tests for the joint significance of our two instruments on the two first-stage regressions. In the first-stage regression predicting anonymization status (Equation 8), the inclusion of the two instruments was statistically significant with an F-stat of 11.17. More important to estimating the interaction effect of interest, the F-stat of the instruments in the first-stage regression predicting the interaction between anonymization and SCR status is 33.25. Thus, the instruments meet the conventional standard for instrument strength of $F > 10$ in both first stages.

The exclusion restriction in this context implies that the availability of the anonymization policy should influence review positivity only through anonymization. One way the exclusion restriction might be violated is if the availability of the policy also affects the characteristics of submitting authors or reviewers, for example if some authors choose not to submit because the policy was introduced. This is a separate selection concern from self-selection into treatment, in which the groups *assigned* to treatment (option available) and control (not available) are statistically different on observables and unobservables. A previous study tested for whether the policy was associated with changes in two productivity characteristics of submitting authors or invited reviewers—their publications and accumulated citations—and found no statistically significant changes (18), consistent with the restriction. Additionally, we examine how the instrument affects four additional variables at the manuscript-level—logged team size (number of authors on submission), probability of a submission being reviewed by at least one SCR, number of realized reviewers, and probability of a submission being desk rejected—using the model specification in Equation 7. Table S5 shows that the anonymization option introduction did not have a statistically significant effect on these manuscript characteristics, further supporting this assumption. Still, the exclusion restriction is an assumption, and these tests do not rule out all possible threats to validity. Regarding author and reviewer characteristics, we are unable to test for differences between those who can and cannot anonymize within productivity strata. For example, if reviewers exhibit a systematic gender bias, it is possible that the option to anonymize may attract authors of one gender with similar productivity to those in the existing author pool. However, if the gender bias is not fully eliminated through anonymization, then policy availability may shift reviewer positivity by changing the author pool (i.e., not through anonymization alone). Regarding manuscript-level differences, the anonymization option may have attracted lower-quality submissions since authors would be less likely to see negative reputational effects from reviewers, even though editors can still see authors' identities. In this case, reviewers may be more negative for the group of manuscripts with the anonymization policy available through a channel other than anonymization.

By making these three assumptions, the estimates from our analysis are interpreted as the Local Average Treatment Effect (LATE), also known as the Average Treatment Effect (ATE) among compliers. Observations can be conceptually categorized into four groups: Always-takers, never-takers, defiers, and compliers.

Always-takers receive the treatment whether they are assigned to it or not. In this study, we should have no always-takers (i.e., one-sided non-compliance) because submitting authors could not choose to anonymize unless the policy was available to them. There were 18 observations of submissions that were anonymized before the policy was available, but these are possibly administrative errors and were removed for analysis. Never-takers do not receive the treatment regardless of their assignment. When anonymization was an option, those who did not anonymize—most submitters in our sample—are considered never-takers. However, we cannot observe the proportion of those who submitted when anonymization was not an option who were never-takers. We assume the proportion is similar to that on the anonymized (treated) side. Defiers are those who would receive the opposite treatment from what they are assigned (i.e., anonymize if option is not available or don't anonymize if option is available). For the instrumental variables approach, it must be assumed that defiers do not exist in our sample. Compliers are those who receive the treatment that they are assigned.

Conceptually, the LATE is the effect of assignment (anonymization policy availability) on the outcome (positivity) scaled by the proportion of observations in the complier group. Among the submissions that received reviews, 28,666 had the anonymization option (assigned to treatment) and 84,566 did not (assigned to control). 8,742 submissions were anonymized so the proportion of compliers on the assigned to treatment side is 30.5%. A potential concern is the low take-up rate (~8% overall, ~30% when option was available), since our causal estimates apply only to authors who are induced to anonymize. This set of authors may vary with different policy implementations.

Additionally, we restricted our analysis to papers that received reviews (55.72% of all submissions), i.e. editors did not desk-reject. This restriction is unlikely to bias our results because neither the instrument nor the treatment affected the information editors see and therefore should not have affected their desk-rejection decisions. Consistent with this argument, we found that the instrument did not affect desk-rejection probability (Table S5).

Analyzing SCR Positivity During and After COVID-19 Travel Restrictions. We conduct an additional exploratory analysis to test whether the informational mechanism contributes to SCR homophily. Following prior theoretical and empirical evidence (1–3), we assume that reviewers with more private information about a submission are also more positive.

We leverage the 2020 global outbreak of COVID-19 and the subsequent public health measures and travel restrictions imposed in many countries as an unexpected shock that reduced domestic and international mobility for researchers. Specifically, we define the global travel disruption period as January 2020 through December 2021 (*i.e.,* 2020Q1-2021Q4). Venues for research dissemination like conferences were cancelled or changed modalities from in-person to virtual. Prior research finds that conferences facilitate both intentional and serendipitous knowledge transfer (19). We assume that disruptions to in-person events reduce the information that reviewers would have prior to reviewing a work, while leaving other determinates of reviews, like tastes, unchanged. We also assume that, without COVID-related restrictions, geographically proximate authors and reviewers are more likely to attend the same events compared to distant pairs. If so, then a disruption to in-person events would likely reduce SCRs information more than non-SCRs. Thus, if private information is a major driver of SCR homophily, then we expect that the intensity of SCR homophily to decrease during the COVID-19 disruption period. However, if the intensity of SCR homophily is unchanged during this period, this would suggest that information is not a major driver.

To test these hypotheses, we bin reviews into year-quarters based on invitation date. We then estimate the linear model specified in Equation 14 separately for each bin from 2018Q1 to 2022Q4. Manuscript fixed effects are included to control for manuscript quality, and standard errors are clustered at the manuscript level. Reviewer fixed effects are not included, since a vast majority of reviewers did not submit multiple

reviews within the same three-year span, and so would be omitted from the regression on the year-quarter subsets.

$$Positivity_{ij} = \alpha_i + \beta_1 SCR_{ij} + \epsilon_{ij} \quad (14)$$

Figure S5 shows the results from these regressions. The area spanning the COVID-19 disruption period from 2020Q1 to 2021Q4 is shaded in blue. Notably, SCRs were more positive than non-SCRs across all quarters of reviewer invitation. It is not visually apparent that SCRs during the disruption period were less relatively positive compared to those before and after. This motivates the second part of the analysis, which is a statistical test of difference in SCR homophily intensity before, during, and after the COVID period.

Second, we pool reviewers invited to review before, during, and after the COVID-19 disruption period, encoded as a categorical variable. We then use a linear model to estimate the interaction effect between SCR status and the reviewers' invitation date relative to the disruption period. Equation 15 specifies this model, which includes positivity as the dependent variable and journal fixed effects, the disruption period categorical term, the SCR status term, and an interaction term on the right-hand side. Again, standard errors are clustered at the manuscript level. The primary effect of interest in this analysis is the coefficient of the interaction term for reviewers invited during and after the disruption period. If the estimate is negative, statistically significant, and of a similar magnitude compared to that for SCRs in the before period, this suggests information is the primary mechanism underlying SCR bonus Positivity.

We do not include manuscript fixed effects in this analysis because very few manuscripts had reviewers invited across multiple periods. Moreover, the small subset of manuscripts that *did* span periods (i.e., with reviewers invited both before and during the disruption) likely differ systematically from those that did not. Specifically, such manuscripts would have remained in review for a longer duration, increasing the likelihood that earlier reviewers—invited during the "before" period—were relatively more positive. If early reviewers had not been positive, the manuscript likely would have been rejected earlier in the process, preventing later reviewers from being invited. As a result, estimates from this subset could be biased by selection effects tied to review timing.

$$Positivity_{ij} = \gamma_i + \beta_1 rev_invite_period_i + \beta_2 SCR_{ij} + \beta_3 rev_invite_period_i * SCR_{ij} + \epsilon_{ij} \quad (15)$$

Results from this regression, displayed in Table S11, show that reviewers generally decreased in positivity over time. In line with our hypothesis, the interaction coefficient for SCRs and reviewer invitation during the disruption period is -0.0134 ($p < 0.05$), suggesting that the negative information shock reduced SCR homophily. However, the change is less than one-fifth that of the main SCR homophily coefficient. Thus, it appears that the information mechanism had a modest contribution to the overall positivity of SCRs.

This result is only suggestive for several reasons. First, using journal fixed effects rather than manuscript fixed effects in the second part of the analysis precludes controlling for manuscript quality and other confounders. Second, we do not directly observe whether reviewers had less information going into a review during the COVID-19 disruption period. Our assumption that travel restrictions are linked to less information could be violated if reviewers received similar information from online preprints or virtual presentations. On the other hand, information from virtual sources could also be behind the modest negative effect we observe, and information may play a larger role in SCR positivity than we conclude. Third, we operationalize the COVID-19 disruption period as 2020 and 2021 to approximate the period when lockdown and travel restriction policies were most prevalent across the world. However, a finer-grained measure of policies at the local level would give a more accurate estimate of the disruption effect on SCR homophily. Although the results suggest that information is not the main driver of SCR homophily, future work is needed to elucidate the effects of information and tastes.

Positive and Not-Positive Codes for Reviewer Response Categories. The categorical responses coded as 0 (i.e., recommendation to reject) include, "Reject (average work that adds little new knowledge to the field)", "Reject (contains basic errors and faulty judgements)", "Unsatisfactory revision", "Reject (adds little new knowledge to the field; may be publishable in an archival journal)", "Reject (contains basic errors and

faulty judgements; not publishable in any journal)", "Reject but may resubmit (may be publishable in this journal following these substantial revisions)", "Reject", "Reject as a Letter but may be resubmitted for consideration as a regular paper after expansion and/or revision", "Reject ", "Reject as a Letter but can be considered as a regular paper in current form", "Reject as a letter but may be resubmitted for consideration as a regular paper after expansion and/or revision", "Reject (not publishable even with revisions)", "Reject as a fast track communication but may be resubmitted for consideration as a regular paper after expansion and/or revision", "Reject (adds little knowledge to the field; may be publishable in an archival journal)", "Article is fundamentally flawed", "Reject as a frontline article but may be resubmitted for consideration as a regular paper after expansion and/or revision", "Reject as a fast track communication but can be considered as a regular paper in current form", "Reject as a letter but can be considered as a regular paper in current form", "Manuscript is fundamentally flawed", and "Reject as a frontline article but can be considered as a regular paper in current form." While some of these categories hint at possible acceptance in the future, they require the manuscript to be resubmitted which would appear in the data as a separate manuscript submission.

The categorical responses coded as 1 (i.e., recommendation to accept) include, "Accept", "Amendments required before acceptance", "Major revision and re-submission recommended (with these substantial revisions I expect that the article would make a significant contribution to the literature)", "Major revision required before acceptance", "Revisions required before acceptance (only changes to the text are required)", "Revisions are required", "Major revisions required before acceptance", "Accept after optional revisions", "Accept in current form", "Revisions required before acceptance", "Article requires revisions to meet accepted scientific standards", "Article displays scientific rigour - further revisions are optional", "Manuscript displays scientific rigour - further revisions are optional", "Manuscript requires revisions to meet accepted scientific standards", "Article displays significant scientific rigour", and "Manuscript displays significant scientific rigour."

Countries by Income Group. High-income countries (HIC): Australia, Austria, Bahrain, Belgium, Brunei Darussalam, Canada, Chile, Cocos (Keeling) Islands, Croatia, Cyprus, Czech Republic, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Gibraltar, Greece, Hong Kong, Hungary, Iceland, Ireland, Isle of Man, Israel, Italy, Japan, Korea (Republic of), Kuwait, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Macao, Malta, Martinique, Monaco, Netherlands, New Caledonia, New Zealand, Norway, Oman, Panama, Poland, Portugal, Puerto Rico, Qatar, Romania, Saudi Arabia, Singapore, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Taiwan, Trinidad and Tobago, United Arab Emirates, United Kingdom, United States Minor Outlying Islands, United States of America, Uruguay

Upper-middle-income countries (UMIC): Albania, Argentina, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Belarus, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Botswana, Brazil, Bulgaria, China, Colombia, Costa Rica, Cuba, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, Fiji, French Guiana, Gabon, Georgia, Guatemala, Iraq, Jamaica, Jordan, Kazakhstan, Libya, Macedonia (the former Yugoslav Republic of), Malaysia, Mauritius, Mexico, Moldova (Republic of), Montenegro, Namibia, Paraguay, Peru, Russian Federation, Serbia, South Africa, Thailand, Turkey

Low- and Lower-middle-income countries (LLMIC): Afghanistan, Algeria, Bangladesh, Benin, Bolivia (Plurinational State of), Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cameroon, Congo, Congo (Democratic Republic of the), Côte d'Ivoire, Egypt, Ethiopia, Ghana, India, Indonesia, Iran (Islamic Republic of), Kenya, Korea (Democratic People's Republic of), Kyrgyzstan, Lebanon, Lesotho, Madagascar, Malawi, Mali, Mauritania, Mongolia, Morocco, Mozambique, Myanmar, Nepal, Niger, Nigeria, Pakistan, Palestine, State of, Papua New Guinea, Philippines, Rwanda, Senegal, Somalia, Sri Lanka, Sudan, Swaziland, Syrian Arab Republic, Tajikistan, Tanzania, Tanzania, United Republic of, Togo, Tunisia, Uganda, Ukraine, Uzbekistan, Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of), Viet Nam, Yemen, Zambia, Zimbabwe

Submission Country Robustness Checks. First, we investigate whether using the lead author's country as the country of a submission changes our findings. In our data, lead and corresponding authors are most often from the same country, and even more often from the same region. Thus, we do not anticipate different findings using the lead author instead of the corresponding author. Table S7 shows that estimates of SCR homophily are similar whether corresponding or lead author country is used as reference. The number of observations differ between these models because corresponding authors were required to self-report their

country upon submission whereas lead authors were not. Comparing the first two models in Table S10, differences in estimates of access to SCRs appear trivial between using corresponding or lead author. Therefore, evidence provided of geographical representation bias is robust when lead author country is substituted for corresponding author country in determining where a submission is from.

Second, we use two subsets to validate the country of the corresponding author as a proxy for the country of a submitted manuscript. The regional team subset contains submissions with authors all from the same region (see Countries by Region), and the national team subset consists of submissions with authors all from the same country. A minority of submissions in our data are international, and even fewer span more than one region, so we do not expect findings to change using these subsets. Table S8 confirms that estimates of SCR homophily are similar between the national, regional, and full data. Again, Table S10 confirms that estimates of access to SCRs are similar in these subsets, where the relevant comparison is between the first model to the third and fourth models. We conclude that our main findings are robust when looking only at national or regional teams, who might be expected to have the stronger SCR effects.

Countries by Region. Africa: Algeria, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cameroon, Congo, Congo (Democratic Republic of the), Côte d'Ivoire, Egypt, Ethiopia, Gabon, Ghana, Kenya, Lesotho, Libya, Madagascar, Malawi, Mali, Mauritania, Mauritius, Morocco, Mozambique, Namibia, Niger, Nigeria, Rwanda, Senegal, Somalia, South Africa, Sudan, Swaziland, Tanzania, United Republic of, Togo, Tunisia, Uganda, Zambia, Zimbabwe

Asia: Afghanistan, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Bahrain, Bangladesh, Benin, Brunei Darussalam, China, Cyprus, Georgia, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Iran (Islamic Republic of), Iraq, Israel, Japan, Jordan, Kazakhstan, Korea (Democratic People's Republic of), Korea (Republic of), Kuwait, Kyrgyzstan, Lebanon, Macao, Malaysia, Mongolia, Myanmar, Nepal, Oman, Pakistan, Palestine, State of, Philippines, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Singapore, Sri Lanka, Syrian Arab Republic, Taiwan, Tajikistan, Thailand, Turkey, United Arab Emirates, Uzbekistan, Viet Nam, Yemen

Europe: Albania, Austria, Belarus, Belgium, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Botswana, Bulgaria, Croatia, Czech Republic, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Gibraltar, Greece, Hungary, Iceland, Ireland, Isle of Man, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Macedonia (the former Yugoslav Republic of), Malta, Moldova (Republic of), Monaco, Montenegro, Netherlands, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Russian Federation, Serbia, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Ukraine, United Kingdom

Latin America and the Caribbean: Argentina, Bolivia (Plurinational State of), Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica, Cuba, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, French Guiana, Guatemala, Jamaica, Martinique, Mexico, Panama, Paraguay, Peru, Puerto Rico, Trinidad and Tobago, Uruguay, Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of)

Northern America: Canada, United States of America

Oceania: Australia, Cocos (Keeling) Islands, Fiji, New Caledonia, New Zealand, Papua New Guinea, United States Minor Outlying Islands

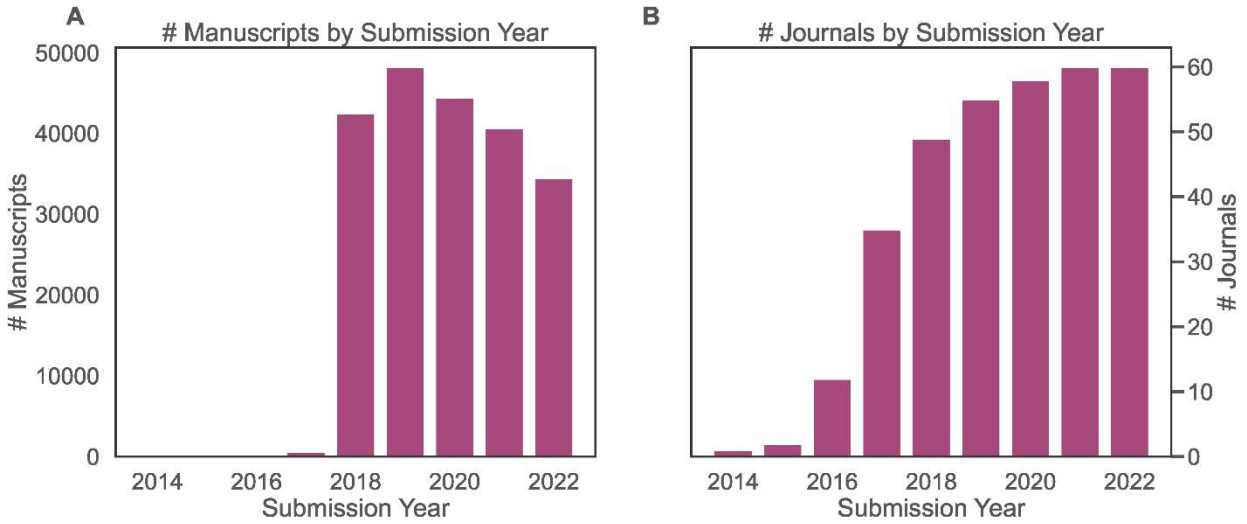


Fig. S1.
Number of manuscripts and journals by year. **A:** The modal manuscript received a final decision in 2019. **B:** Journals increased every year until reaching 60 in 2021.

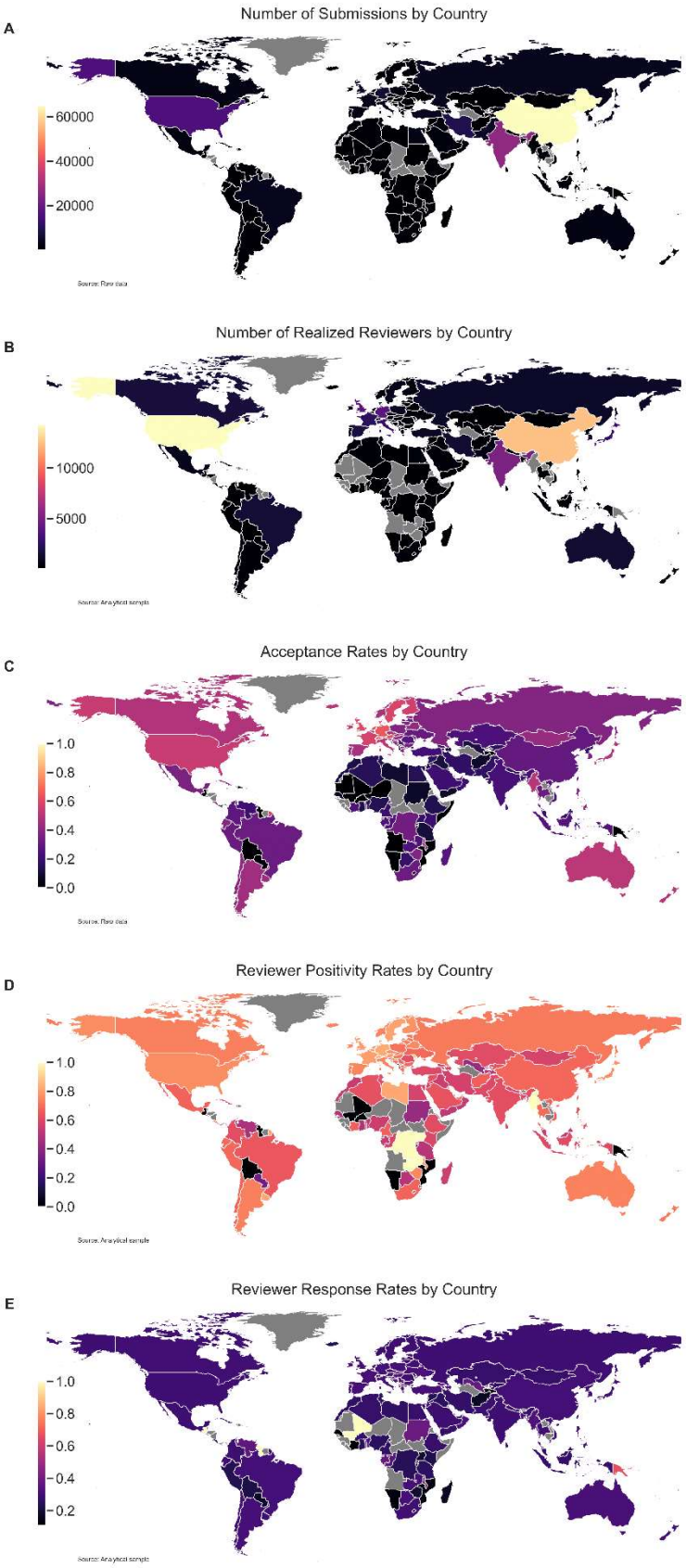

A
Number of Submissions by Country
60000
40000
20000
B
Number of Realized Reviewers by Country
10000
5000
C
Acceptance Rates by Country
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
D
Reviewer Positivity Rates by Country
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
E
Reviewer Response Rates by Country
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2

Fig. S2.
Key variables by country. Countries with no data or with less than 100 submissions are in gray. **A:** Number of submissions. **B:** Number of unique realized reviewers. **C:** Acceptance rates. **D:** Reviewer positivity (recommendation to accept) rates. **E:** Reviewer response rates.

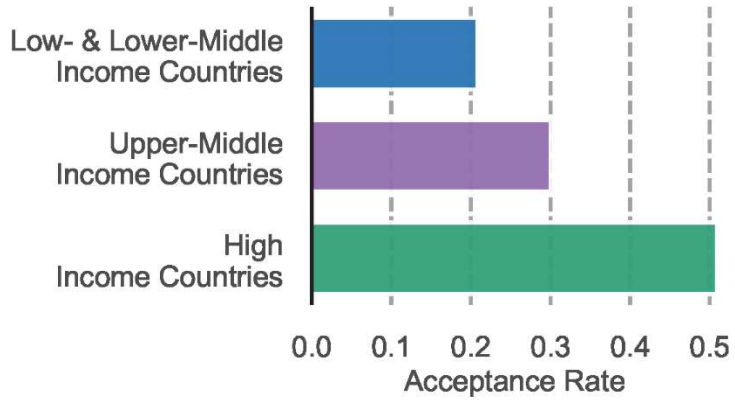


Fig. S3.
Acceptance rates by country income group from the raw data. Acceptance rate is directly related to GDP per capita.

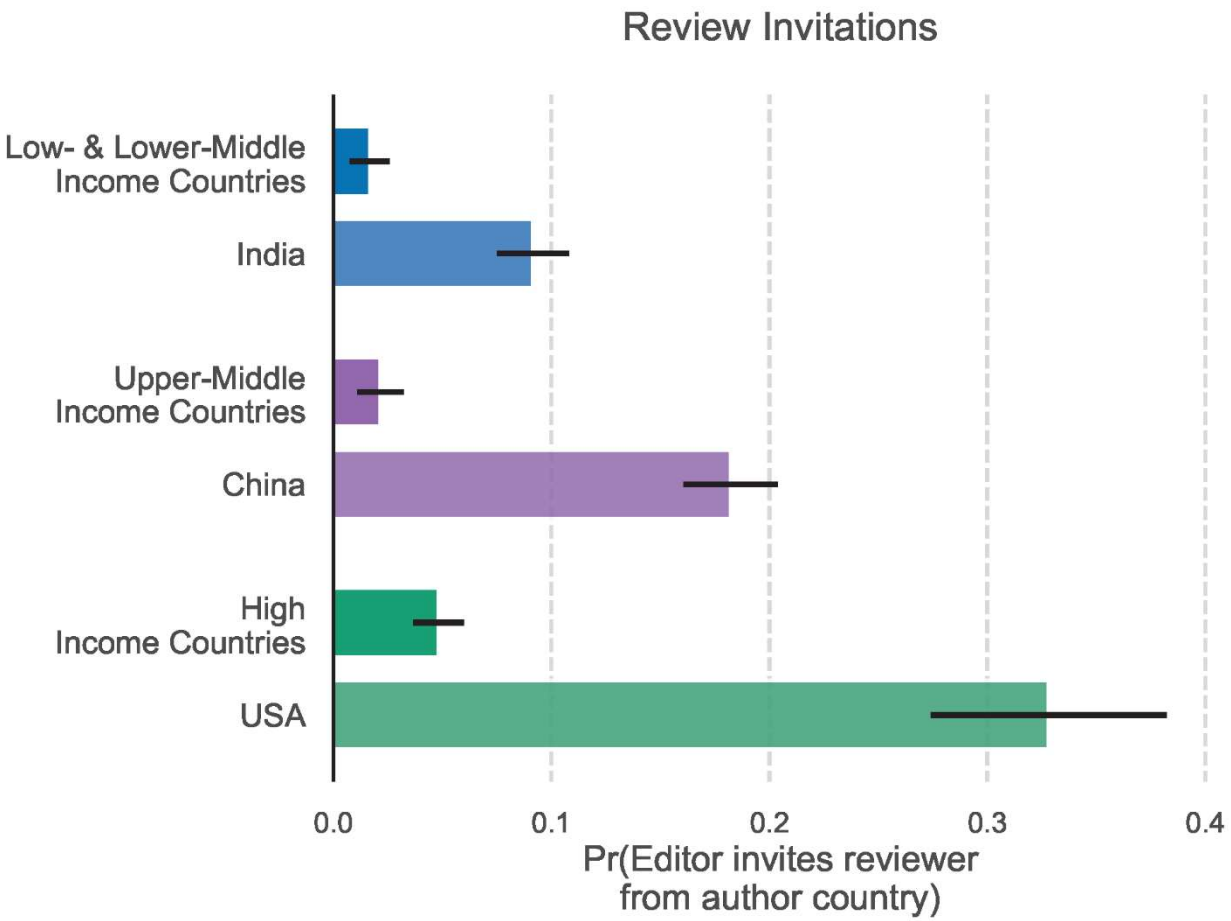


Fig. S4.
Countries well-represented in the reviewer pool are more likely to get SCRs. Wealthier countries of similar representation have more SCR access. See Equation 5 in Model Specifications for formal model. Regression estimates for SCR invitation and access by country income groups both with and without the three most represented countries is in Table S9. Editor invitation rates of SCRs by country income group, separating out the country with the most reviewers in each group. Realized reviewer counterpart is in Fig. 2B.

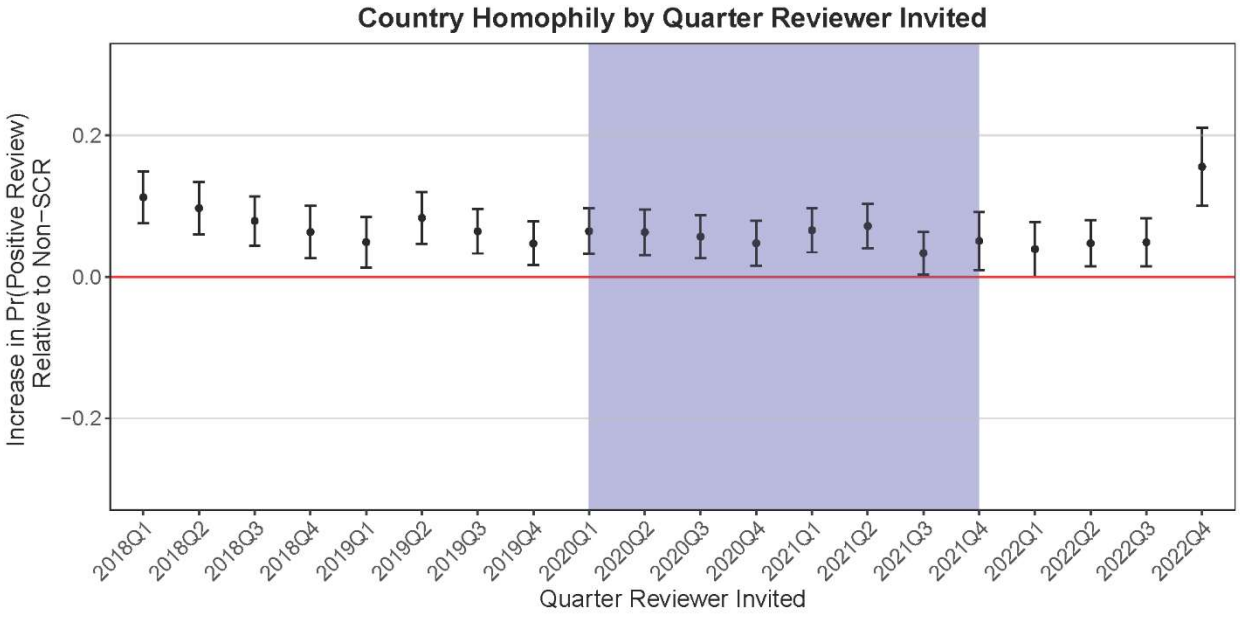


Fig. S5.
SCRs were more positive than non-SCRs in every quarter. Estimates from running regressions on subsets of data by year-quarter reviewer was invited. See Equation 14 for formal model. Area shaded in blue are quarters during COVID-19 disruption period.

Table S1.
Summary statistics for data on realized reviews.

Variable	obs	unique	mean	stdev	median	min	max
Journal	238,097	60					
Manuscript	238,097	113,232					
Author Country	238,028	146					
Reviewer Country	237,562	142					
Submission Year	238,097	5	2019.86	1.35	2020	2018	2022
Decision Year	237,890	6	2020.05	1.34	2020	2018	2023
accepted	238,097	2	0.6234	0.4845		0.0	1.0
rev.positive	238,097	2	0.7040	0.4565		0.0	1.0
SCR	238,097	2	0.1467	0.3539		0.0	1.0
anonymized	238,097	2	0.0574	0.2326		0.0	1.0
national	238,036	2	0.7429	0.4370		0.0	1.0
regional	238,092	2	0.8307	0.3750		0.0	1.0
team.size	238,092		4.7942	3.3715	4.0	1.0	99.0

Note: SCR=Same-Country Reviewer

Table S2.
Summary statistics for data on invited reviews.

Variable	obs	unique	mean	stdev	median	min	max
Journal	787,055	60					
Manuscript	787,055	114,069					
Author Country	786,812	146					
Reviewer Country	781,508	160					
Submission Year	787,055	5	2019.78	1.34	2020	2018	2022
Decision Year	786,464	6	2019.99	1.32	2020	2018	2023
accepted	787,055	2	0.6348	0.4815		0.0	1.0
rev.responded	787,055	2	0.3025	0.4593		0.0	1.0
SCR	787,055	2	0.1194	0.3243		0.0	1.0
anonymized	787,055	2	0.0561	0.2300		0.0	1.0
national	786,855	2	0.7415	0.4378		0.0	1.0
regional	787,023	2	0.8285	0.3770		0.0	1.0
team.size	787,023		4.7911	3.3416	4.0	1.0	99.0

Note: SCR=Same-Country Reviewer

Table S3.
Linear probability models measuring response and positivity bonuses of SCRs.

	Dependent Variable			
	Submitted Review		Review Positive	
SCR	0.0476***	0.0474***	0.0506***	0.0478***
	(0.0037)	(0.0023)	(0.0061)	(0.0051)
Team Size Control	0.0089***		0.0495***	
	(0.0024)		(0.0031)	
Anonymity Control	-0.0596***		-0.0348***	
	(0.0171)		(0.0053)	
Auth. Country Control	Y	N	Y	N
Journal FE	Y	N	Y	N
Manuscript FE	N	Y	N	Y
Reviewer FE	Y	Y	Y	Y
Observations	700,965	692,233	203,444	181,228

Note: * < 0.05, ** < 0.01, *** < 0.001. SCR=Same-Country Reviewers, FE=Fixed Effects, Y=Yes, N=No. Standard errors in parentheses clustered at the level of the fixed effects.

Table S4.
Heterogenous estimates for benefits of SCRs across country income groups.

	Dependent Var: Review is Positive
SCR	0.0297***
	(0.0080)
SCR*UMIC	0.0361**
	(0.0116)
SCR*LLMIC	0.0104
	(0.0174)
Manuscript FE	Y
Reviewer FE	Y
Observations	181,038

Note: * < 0.05, ** < 0.01, *** < 0.001. SCR=Same-Country Reviewers, FE=Fixed Effects, Y=Yes. Standard errors in parentheses clustered at the level of the fixed effects.

Table S5.
The effect of anonymization option rollout on characteristics of submissions

Dependent Variable	ln(Team Size)	SCR on Panel	Number of Reviewers	Not Desk Rejected
PolicyAvail	-0.1697 (0.0993)	0.0022 (0.0083)	0.0072 (0.0225)	-0.0197 (0.02457)
Submission Year-Month FE	Y	Y	Y	Y
Journal FE	Y	Y	Y	Y
Observations	113,194	113,197	113,197	204,723

Note: * < 0.05, ** < 0.01, *** < 0.001. FE=Fixed Effects, Y=Yes. Standard errors in parentheses clustered at the level of the fixed effects.

Table S6.
Effect of Anonymization on Benefits of SCRs.

	Dependent Var: Review is Positive		
	ITT	**OLS**	**IV**
SCR	0.0539*** (0.0081)	0.0495*** (0.0048)	0.0516*** (0.0077)
PolicyAvail	-0.0170 (0.0092)		
SCR*PolicyAvail	-0.0100 (0.0100)		
Anon			-0.0370* (0.0184)
SCR*Anon		-0.0263 (0.0178)	-0.0067 (0.0205)
Team Size Control	0.0490*** (0.0046)		0.0486*** (0.0043)
Auth. Country Control	Y	N	Y
Journal FE	Y	N	Y
Manuscript FE	N	Y	N
Reviewer FE	Y	Y	Y
Invite Year-Month FE	Y	N	Y
Observations	203,440	181,228	203,440

Note: * < 0.05, ** < 0.01, *** < 0.001. SCR=Same-Country Reviewers, FE=Fixed Effects, Y=Yes, N=No. Standard errors in parentheses clustered at the level of the fixed effects.

Table S7.
Comparing Estimates using Corresponding or Lead Author to identify country of submission.

Review is Positive	Corresponding	Lead
SCR	0.0478***	0.0475***
	(0.0051)	(0.0051)
Manuscript FE	Y	Y
Reviewer FE	Y	Y
Observations	181,228	181,030

Note: * < 0.05, ** < 0.01, *** < 0.001. SCR=Same-Country Reviewers, FE=Fixed Effects, Y=Yes. Standard errors in parentheses clustered at the level of the fixed effects.

Table S8.
Comparing Estimates among National, Regional, and All Teams.

Review is Positive	All Teams	National	Regional
SCR	0.0478*** (0.0051)	0.0410*** (0.0063)	0.0414*** (0.0058)
Manuscript FE	Y	Y	Y
Reviewer FE	Y	Y	Y
Observations	181,228	127,858	145,796

Note: * < 0.05, ** < 0.01, *** < 0.001. SCR=Same-Country Reviewers, FE=Fixed Effects, Y=Yes. Standard errors in parentheses clustered at the level of the fixed effects.

Table S9.
Linear probability models measuring invitation rates and access to country homophily by corresponding author geography.

	Dependent Variable			
	Invited Reviewer is SCR		Realized Reviewer is SCR	
HIC	0.1163***	0.0484***	0.1101***	0.0497***
	(0.0097)	(0.0059)	(0.0093)	(0.0075)
UMIC	0.1458***	0.0217***	0.2111***	0.0323***
	(0.0100)	(0.0054)	(0.0107)	(0.0069)
LLMIC	0.0666***	0.0167***	0.0987***	0.0266***
	(0.0061)	(0.0046)	(0.0089)	(0.0064)
USA		0.3281***		0.3027***
		(0.0276)		(0.0263)
China		0.1823***		0.2659***
		(0.0110)		(0.0111)
India		0.0916***		0.1369***
		(0.0083)		(0.0149)
Team Size Control	0.0047	0.0013	0.0096**	0.0020
	(0.0026)	(0.0019)	(0.0032)	(0.0024)
Anonymity Control	0.0118	0.0174**	0.0102	0.0154
	(0.0078)	(0.0080)	(0.0097)	(0.0099)
Journal FE	Y	Y	Y	Y
Observations	786,232	786,232	237,823	237,823

Note: * < 0.05, ** < 0.01, *** < 0.001. FE=Fixed Effects, Y=Yes. Standard errors in parentheses clustered at the level of the fixed effects.

Table S10.
Comparing Access between All Teams using Corresponding Author and National and Regional Teams and All Team using Lead Author.

	Dependent Variable			
	Corresponding Author/ All Teams	Lead Author	National Teams	Regional Teams
HIC	0.1101***	0.0982***	0.1275***	0.1124***
	(0.0093)	(0.0117)	(0.0112)	(0.0101)
UMIC	0.2111***	0.1969***	0.2224***	0.2186***
	(0.0107)	(0.0105)	(0.0106)	(0.0107)
LLMIC	0.0987***	0.0844***	0.1100***	0.1056***
	(0.0089)	(0.0090)	(0.0090)	(0.0090)
Team Size Control	0.0096**	0.0094**	0.0244***	0.0148***
	(0.0032)	(0.0033)	(0.0037)	(0.0034)
Anonymity Control	0.0102	0.0101	0.0106	0.0106
	(0.0097)	(0.0113)	(0.0115)	(0.0105)
Journal FE	Y	Y	Y	Y
Observations	237,823	237,812	176,667	197,552

Note: * < 0.05, ** < 0.01, *** < 0.001. FE=Fixed Effects, Y=Yes. Standard errors in parentheses clustered at the level of the fixed effects.

Table S11.
Heterogenous estimates for benefits of SCRs by reviewer invite period.

	Dependent Var: Review is Positive
SCR	0.0785***
	(0.0040)
Invited During	-0.0127***
	(0.0025)
Invited After	-0.0376***
	(0.0035)
SCR*Invited During	-0.0134*
	(0.0056)
SCR*Invited After	-0.0009
	(0.0074)
Journal FE	Y
Observations	238,097

Note: * < 0.05, ** < 0.01, *** < 0.001. SCR=Same-Country Reviewer, FE=Fixed Effects, Y=Yes. Standard errors in parentheses clustered at the manuscript level.

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